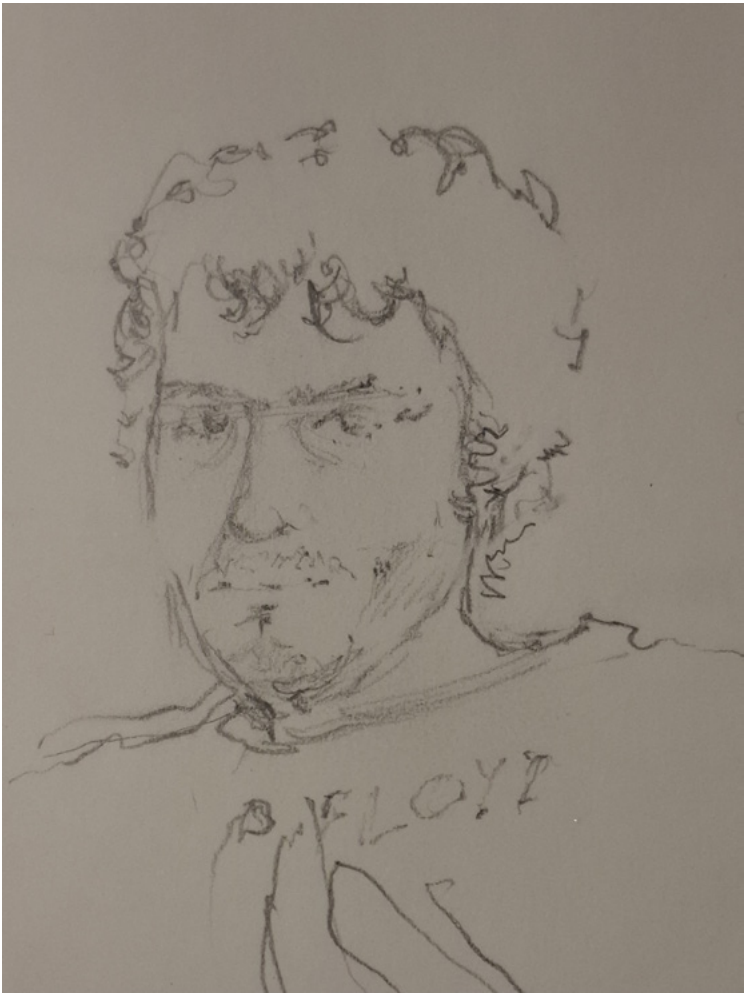




# PORTFOLIO

PAUL FRITZ





Paul Fritz was born in Morges, Switzerland. He lives and works in Lausanne.

Paul completed a Master’s degree in Visual Arts at ECAL in Lausanne, after earning a Bachelor’s degree in Media & Interaction Design at the same institution.

In recent years, his work has been presented at PLATTFORM26 in KBCB, Bienne (2026), FOR in Basel (2025); Spazio Lampo in Chiasso (2025); Lokal.int in Bienne (2025); Treize in Paris (2025); Friendzone in Lausanne (2025); Art Genève (2025); City SALTS in Basel (2024); La Placette in Lausanne (2024); POP GUN in New York (2024); and HEK in Basel (2023). His films have been screened at LUFF in Lausanne, UFM in Lucerne, and HEK in Basel.

He is the recipient of the Fondation Leenaards Tremplin Prize in 2025 and the Walter + Eve Kent Grant in 2024.

### Upcoming

2026 *Another Puppet Show* / Group show curated by Antoine Champenois in **W**, Pantin (FR)

### Personal exhibitions

- 2025 *Priscilla Predator: geboren, leben, sterben* / duo work with Virginie Sistek / Cur. Matthias Liechti & Valérie Keller / **FOR** / Basel (CH)
- 2025 Backstage & Hospitality / Cur. Sabilla Panzeri in **Spazio Lampo** / Chiasso (CH)
- 2025 *i beg to be adored* / Cur. Grégory Sugnaux in **Lokal.int** / Biel (CH)
- 2024 *Dummies* / Cur. Benedikt Wyss in **City SALTS** / Basel (CH)
- 2024 *COTTONMOUTH ou : comment parler de la fin du monde avec assurance* / duo work with Melody Lu in **La Placette** / Lausanne (CH)

### Group exhibitions

- 2026 PLATTFORM 26 / in collaboration with Melody Lu / **Kunsthalle Biel (KBCB)** (CH)
- 2025 *Deemed Visionless* / Cur. David Douard, Julien Langier, Stéfanie Moisdon / **Treize** / Paris (FR)
- 2025 The Lantern show / Cur. Margaux Dewarrat & Stefania Carlotti / **Friendzone** / Lausanne (CH)
- 2025 *Spindream* / **Art Geneva** / Geneve (CH)
- 2024 *You Think You Do but You Dont* / duo exhibition self-organised with Melody Lu / Lausanne (CH)
- 2024 *The World Pulse Beyond My Door* / Cur. Katia Leonelli et Monserrat Mayor pour **POP GUN** / New York (US)
- 2023 *As I Was Moving Ahead* / curation de Justine Stella Knuchel au **Basecamp** / Locarno (CH)
- 2023 *BYOB* / curation de Benedikt Wyss at **HEK** / Basel (CH)

### Films

- 2024 *The Crust That Came Back to Life* / avec Grégory Sugnaux / présenté à **UFM**, Lucerne et au **LUFF**, Lausanne
- 2023 *Public 4 Life* / presented at **UFM**, Luzern and **HEK**, Basel

### Special projects

- 2024 Directing *Post-Scriptum* a film for Grégory Sugnaux’s solo exhibition in **Bibliotheca Hertziana**, Rome
- 2024 *Priscilla Predator vol. 3* / radio project with Virginie Sistek for **Canale Milva** / Chiasso
- 2024 *Priscilla Predator vol.2* / radio project with Virginie Sistek for the show **Slow Friends** on **TRNSTN radio** / Fribourg
- 2023 *Priscilla Predator vol.1* / radio project Virginie Sistek for the show **Mixtape** on RSI / Lugano
- 2022 Directeur artistique sur le film *Piazza Futura* de Kevin B. Lee / Piazza Grande pour le **Locarno Film Festival**
- 2021-2023 Founder of the nomad art space *Grappaa* / Lausanne – Milan

### Press

- 2026 *Marbles, Melodies, Fiction, Zone* / Magazine published by FOR with the exhibition *PRISCILLA PREDATOR*
- 2025 *Questa non è la recensione di una mostra* / article written by Elisabeth Sassi for RSI Cultura

### Prizes & Grants

- 2025 Tremplin Prize Fondation Leenards
- 2024 Grant Walter + Eve Kent (ECAL)
- 2021 METAA (ECAL) Prize
- 2021 BEST PLAKAT 2021

### Studies

- 2023-2025 Master in Arts Visuels à l’ECAL / Lausanne
- 2018-2021 Bachelor in Media & Interaction Design à ECAL / Lausanne
- 2017-2018 Preparatory year in ECAL / Lausanne



*Talking wound, 2025, mixed media, variable dimension*

*Performer* (Talking Wounds) , 2025 - ongoing

is an ongoing sculptural and somewhat performative series I started in 2025. Animatronic human figures with silicone skin are reaching into their own backs, where a large open wound becomes a moving, talking mouth.

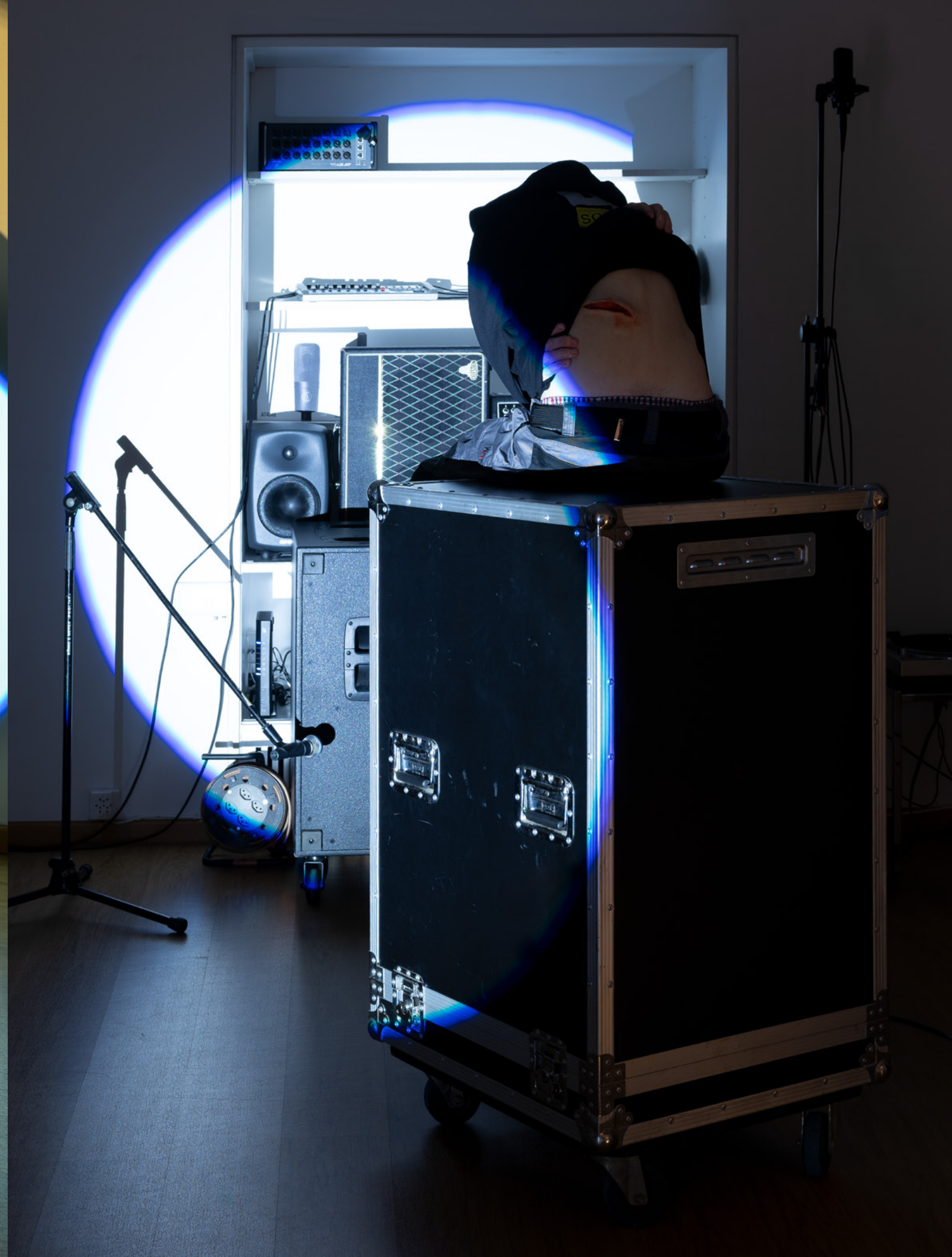
Each time this work is shown, the figures perform a different text.



MOVIE LINK of the performance *Wear & Tear*: <https://vimeo.com/1146932855?fl=pl&fe=sh>

Performance: *Wear & Tear*, 2025, with a text written by Paul R. Levante, Interpreted by Olive Godlee





Installation view of *Backstage & Hospitality*, 2025, Spazio Lampo, Chiasso







« Allez-y, on vous écoute », salle d’audition ou d’interrogatoire ? Finalement, c’est pareil. L’adulte, dans l’expectative du témoignage, de la parole, de la déposition feinte ou sincère, observe le jeu d’acteur, lance l’enregistrement.

Depuis Home Alone jusqu’aux Kardashian, les bébés à l’écran s’étalent, compressés par le poids d’une industrie voyeuriste. La planche à billets s’écrase sur les jeunes corps potelés.

Presse, presse la p’tite orange.

L’œil lubrique du cinéma, dans la lentille de la caméra, capte et ex-sangue l’enfant de ses émotions, de sa vitalité. Il digère avec ses engrenages et ses processus rationalisés, l’imagination de l’intime, la vulnérabilité de ceux qui sont censés échapper à la charpente rigide du cadre professionnel.

Ensuite, le cinéma expulse de son ventre un produit qu’il est capable de vendre, de distribuer, de diffuser, pour les yeux des autres.

Le jus est mis en bouteille.

Pour éviter l’épuisement de la chaîne, on invente de nouveaux pinocchios, substituts numériques sacrifiés au crash de l’exercice de la caméra. Dans ‘Dummies’, deux êtres synthétiques et tridimensionnels sont inspectés et performant au mieux leur humanité au casting du rôle de deux frères.

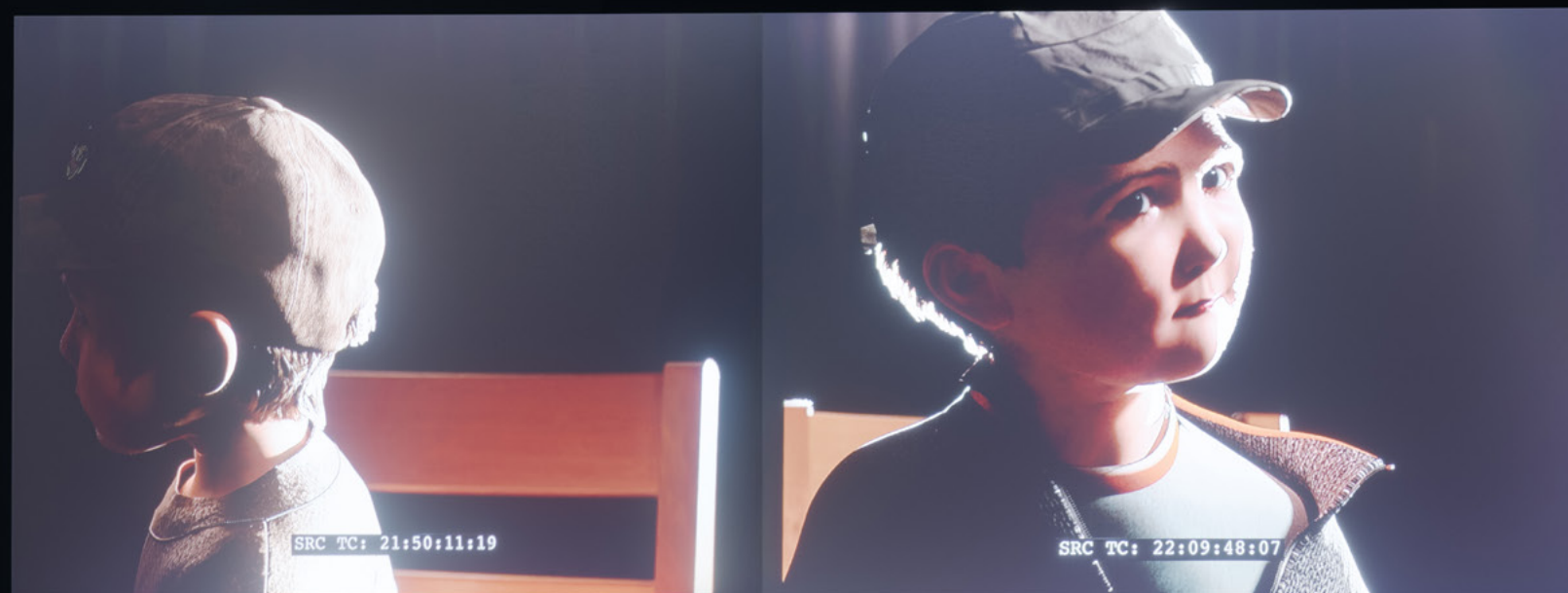
Pour servir le chantier de la reconstitution d’un souvenir autobiographique de Paul Fritz, les outils du cinéma, démolissent et exploitent ce fragment. Il s’agit donc peut être ici d’une expérience qui contraint l’intime au processus d’une production rationalisée et mercantile.

Ou comment passer un peu de nous à la moulinette d’Hollywood.

Text written by Adèle Anstett for the exhibition *DUMMIES*













Stills from *Screen Tests* (part of DUMMIES), 2025, HD video-loop, 3D animation, stereo sound





Installation view of *Screen Tests* (part of DUMMIES), 2025, HD video-loop, 3D animation, stereo sound



The first artwork encountered in the passage leading to the exhibition space was created by Paul Fritz & Melody Lu. Based in the canton of Vaud, the two artists pursue distinct individual practices, while simultaneously developing a collaborative body of work that combines sculptural installations and video. Together, they imagine fictional worlds populated by cartoon-like figures which, beneath a partly playful aesthetic, offer a sharp reflection on real socio-political situations. In their works, the absurd creates an offbeat atmosphere, revealing the potential of the imagination as a form of joyful resilience against defeatism.

The work they show in Plattform26 constitutes the final chapter of a series started in 2024, forming what the artists refer to as their “end-of-the-world trilogy”. In it, the duo address a contemporary anxiety linked to the state of the world through hybrid installations where scales and narratives are blurred. For the context of Plattform26, Fritz and Lu turned their attention to the ritual of passing through a security checkpoint. Although familiar, the scene is marked by several incongruities: a guard with a mascot-like head appears to be dozing, the X-ray machines are miniature and raised on a pedestal, the accumulation of plastic trays at the end of the conveyor belts obstructs smooth circulation. On small screens, an orderly procession of whimsical objects and unexpected relics scrolls past. These suggest the presence of creatures who have deposited their belongings without fulfilling the civic duty of returning the trays to their proper place. In this world suspended between Looney Tunes and everyday lived experience, rational analysis seems futile and gives way to a series of questions: who are these figures passing through the scanner? What danger justifies such a device? And what is the value of such a control system if the agent has fallen asleep?

X-ray imagery belongs to a specific visual regime that the German author and filmmaker Harun Farocki described in 2004 as “operational images” (1). Produced by and for technical development – military, medical or industrial – these images exceed human perceptual capacities. From a “ghostly” perspective, they fulfil a precise function: to inform the power structures that generate them and to participate in the biopolitical project (2). Since 2001, surveillance technologies and X-ray imaging have gradually spread into public space in response to security imperatives, contributing to a norm of public performance that embraces transparency. This practice, which turns bodies inside out in the name of security, simultaneously determines who passes the test and who represents an opaque danger (3).

In their artwork, however, the machinery reveals an essential flaw: the overworked agent dozes off, rendering the control process absurd. This failure thus operates as a form of resistance to soft power at a time when security narratives, frequently nationalist, are used to legitimise acts of violence. By exposing the fragility of the system within a fictional atmosphere, Fritz and Lu highlight the fine line between security and abuse of power, and, while revealing the potential failure of systems in which we place blind trust, allow a glimmer of hope to emerge: the possibility of passing to the other side while escaping the gaze of the machine.

Monica Unser for the exhibition Plattform26 in KBCB



Installation view of *INWARDLY LOOKING* in Kunsthalle Biel (KBCB)









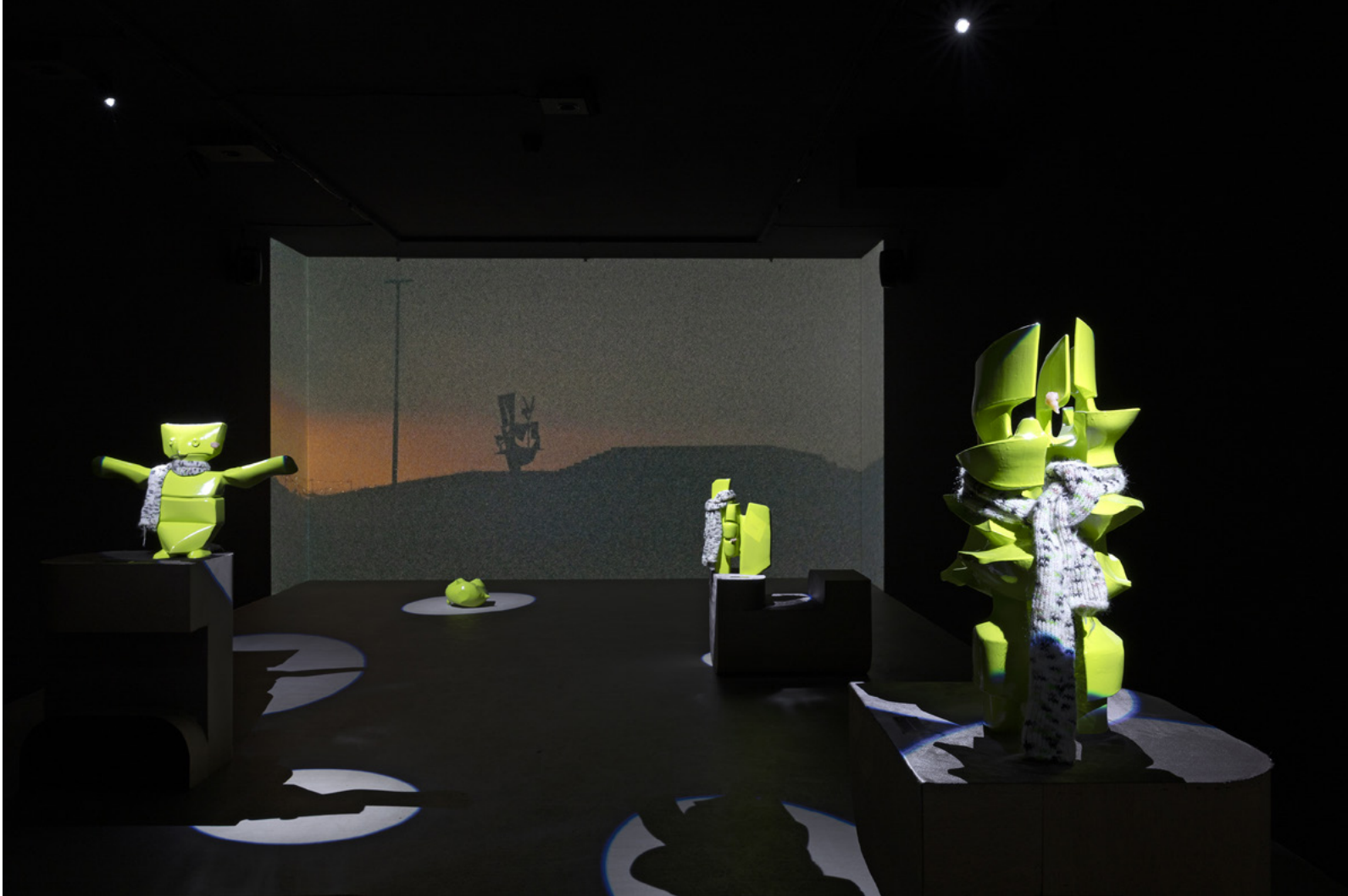


*Priscilla Predator – geboren, leben, sterben, 2025, 31’15’’*

is an "ironically" immersive installation and automated theatre piece. Developed in 2025 alongside Virginie Sistek, it stages the life of Priscilla Predator across episodic chapters, expanding a fictional universe originally created through a series of radio broadcasts following her adventures.

A video documentation of the exhibition can be accessed via the following link:

<https://vimeo.com/1192218399/a9d9215331?fl=pl&fe=sh>



Installation view of *Priscilla Predator – geboren, leben, sterben* in FOR, Basel

**Archive of the Priscilla Predator radiophonic universe**

EPISODE 1, aired in 2023 on RSI Mixtape, Ticino  
<https://shorturl.at/hCF7C>

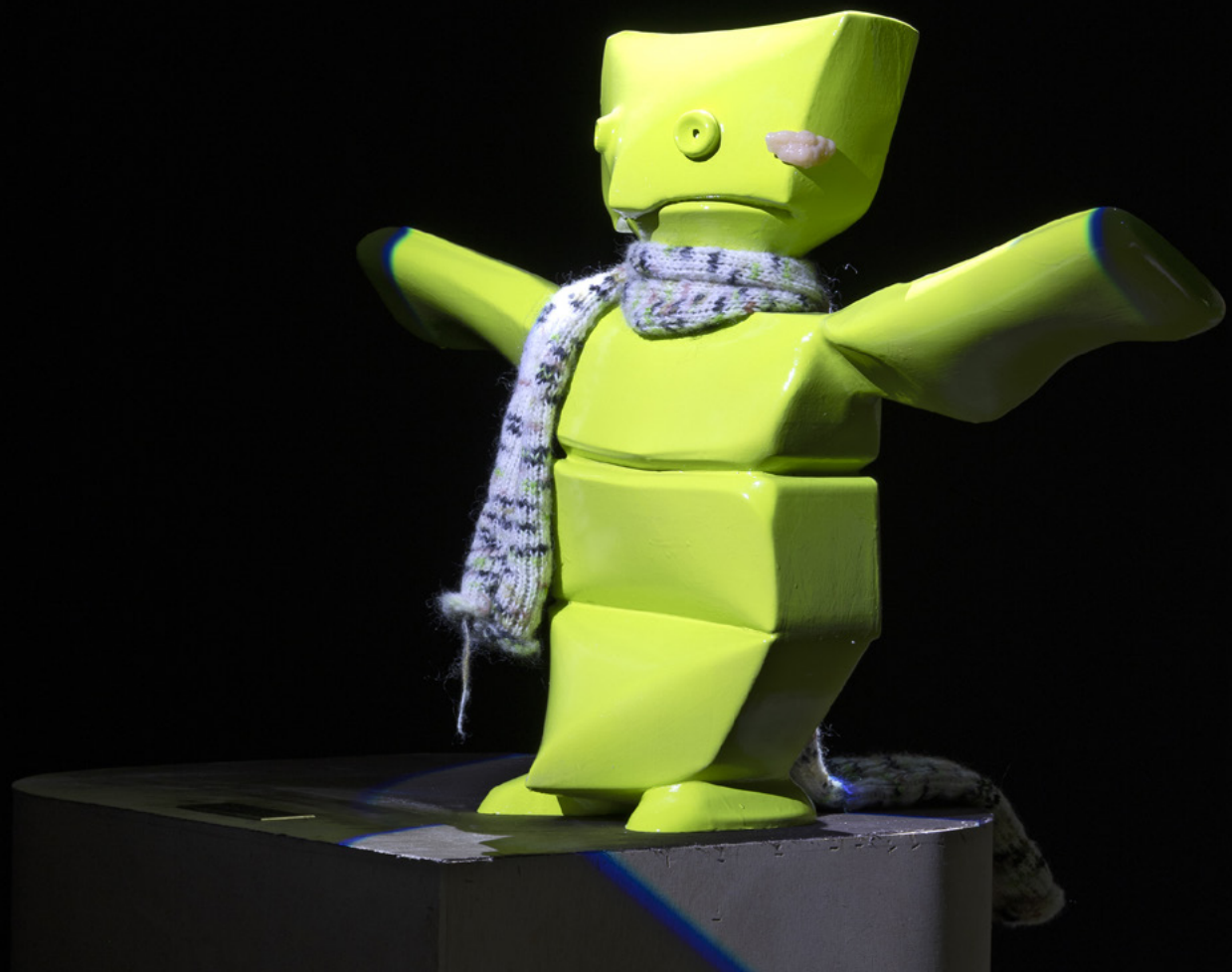
EPISODE 2, aired in 2024 on Transition Radio, Fribourg  
<https://shorturl.at/SzgNx>

EPISODE 3, aired in 2025 on Canale Milva, Ticino  
<https://shorturl.at/vrmet>









*Geschenkpapierzerreissgewissensbisse*, 2025, Paul Fritz & Virginie Sistek, 3D print, paint, lacquer, silicone, knitted wool, custom wooden and velvet base, engraved brass label, 79 x 51 x 21 cm



*Geschmacksübereinstimmungsknacks*, 2025, Paul Fritz & Virginie Sistek, 3D print, paint, lacquer, silicone, knitted wool, custom wooden and velvet base, engraved brass label, 62 x 30 x 33 cm









Stills from the background of *Priscilla Predator* – geboren, leben, sterben



COTTONMOUTH, ou : Comment parler de la fin du monde avec assurance, 2024

is a duo exhibition created in collaboration with artist Melody Lu. A video is installed in the corner of the space on a screen positioned like a public monitor in airports or waiting rooms, where continuous news broadcasts are typically displayed.

The video shows conference rooms, expert panels, television sets, situation rooms, and the podium at the United Nations headquarters. Plush toys are seated in these spaces, positioned as if about to give a speech on a pressing issue. But they seem caught off guard and are unable to speak.

In the rest of the exhibition space, lecture chairs with writing tablets are placed throughout the room. The writing tablets serve as the pedestal for the miniature sets used in the video.



COTTONMOUTH, 2024, 4K video-loop, stereo sound, 5'09"









Still from *COTTONMOUTH*





Still from *COTTONMOUTH*





Still from *COTTONMOUTH*





Details, *INT. WAR ROOM - PENTAGON*



Paul Fritz & Mélody Lu, *INT. WAR ROOM - PENTAGON*, 2024, diverse materials, 42x30cm





Paul Fritz & Mélody Lu, *INT. GENERAL ASSEMBLY HALL*, 2024, diverse materials, 42x30cm



Paul Fritz & Mélody Lu, *INT. LECTERN - BRIEFING ROOM*, 2024, diverse materials, 42x30cm





Paul Fritz & Mélody Lu, *INT. BROADCAST STUDIO*, 2024, diverse materials, 42x30cm



Paul Fritz & Mélody Lu, *INT. PRESS AUDITORIUM*, 2024, diverse materials, 42x30cm



Souvenir Écran, 2024

consists of Souvenir écran I and Souvenir écran II and was presented as a part of a duo exhibition. Both videos are rear-projected onto sheets of paper mounted on a large wooden structure that constrains movement through the space. The visitor starts from the small A4 sheet to a tenfold enlargement of the same page.

The first video is projected onto original typewriter paper with a visible watermark. The second is projected onto an enlarged version of the same sheet, where the fibers, texture, and watermark are also visible. Both videos show animated storyboards depicting a fight between two young boys.



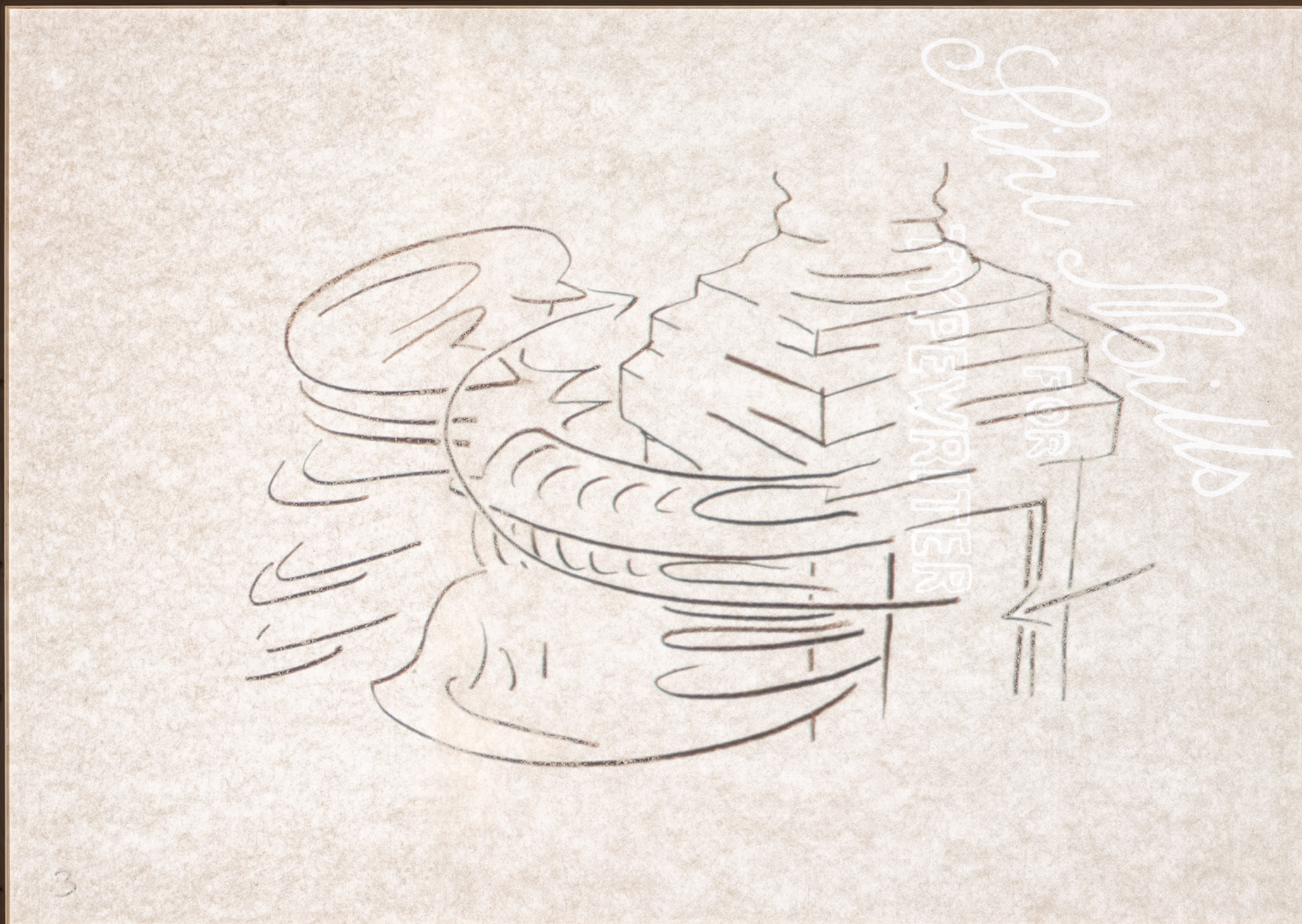
Souvenir Écran I, 2024, video loop, 29,7 x 21 cm





*Untitled*, 2024, wood, curtains, paper and felt, 460 x 430 x 250 cm









*Storyboard I*, 2024, video loop, 29.7 x 21 cm

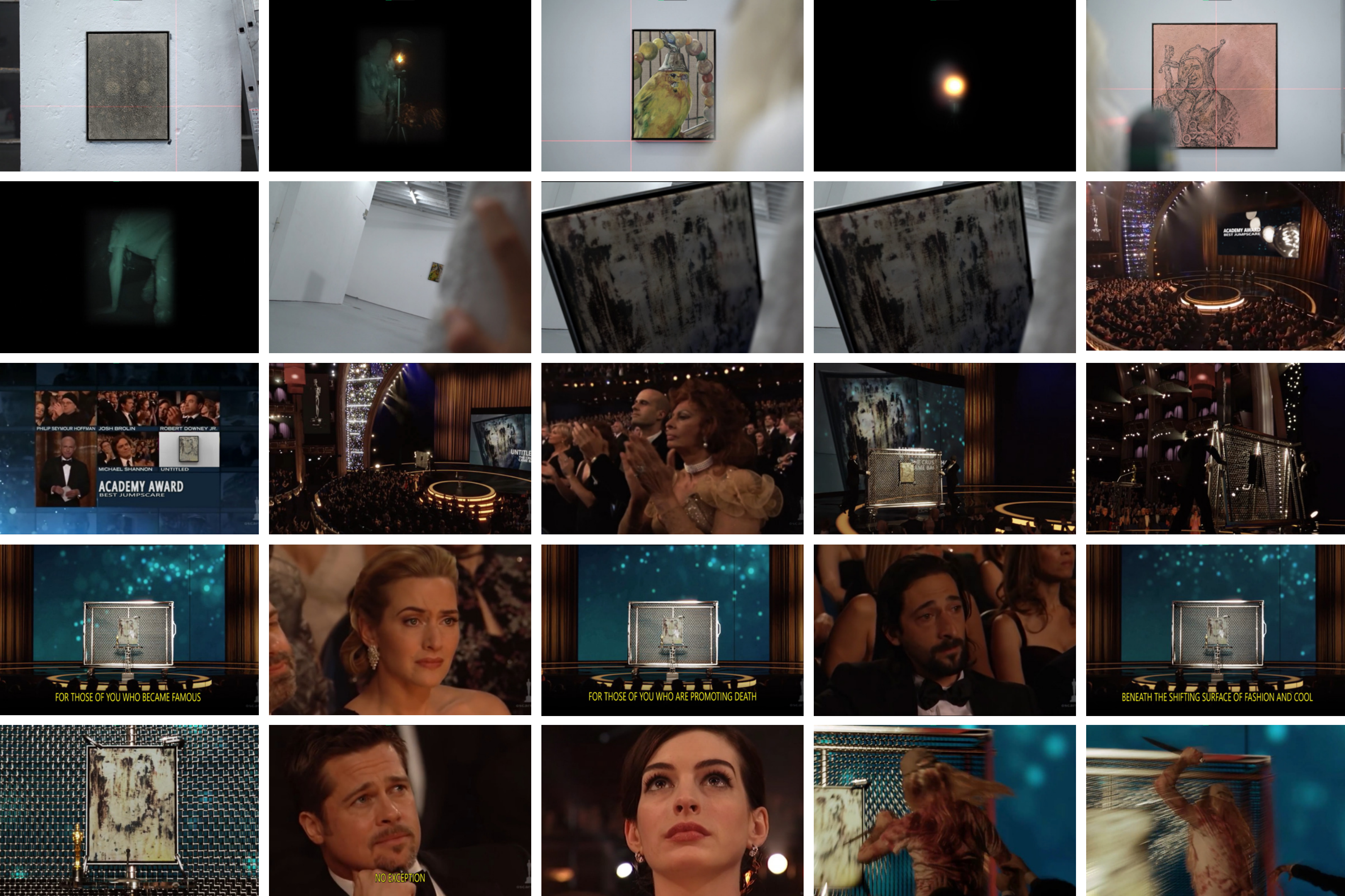


*The Crust That Came Back to Life*, 2024, 7'30"

An art handler is hunted down by a mysterious killer.  
Meanwhile, a painting gives an award acceptance speech.  
Stranger things have happened.







Stills from *The Crust That Came Back to Life*



TWENTY-FIRST CENTURY FOLK, 2023, four-channel SD video, 11'38"

If a tree falls in a forest and no one is around to hear it, does it make a sound?

And if so, what about the footage of a taxidermied daeodon knocking on your door at 3AM captured on your RING camera?

If you never bothered to look, did it really happen?

Or else, a hacked livestream feed broadcasted from home security cameras proves that inanimate objects can move to the sound of the flute, yet there are no viewers to witness it.

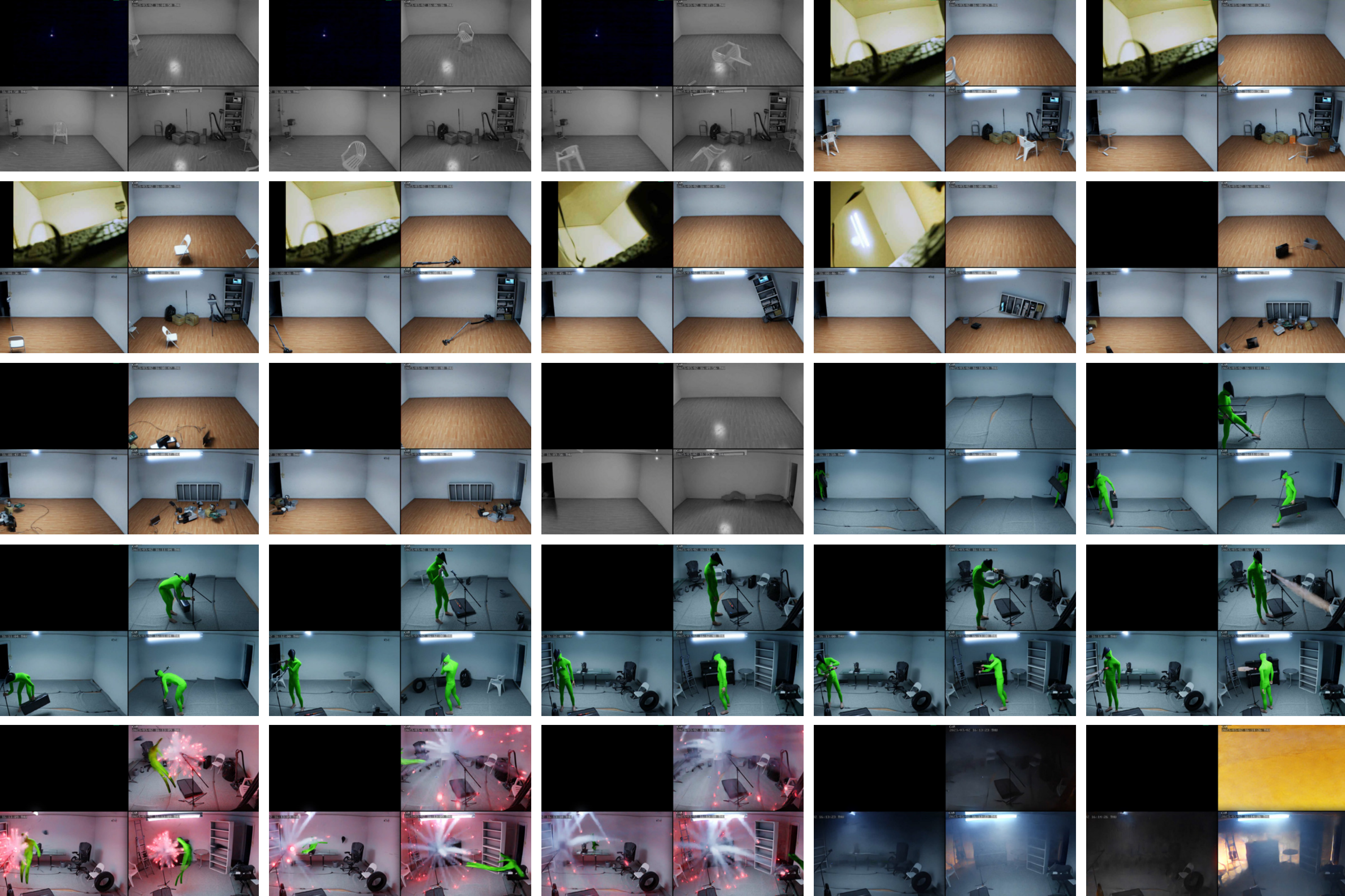
Is it really happening right now?

What could be happening right now, when everything is captured, and no one is watching?



Poster of *Twenty-First-Century-Folk*





Stills from *Twenty-First-Century-Folk*



*PUBLIC 4 LIFE*, 2022, 10'00"

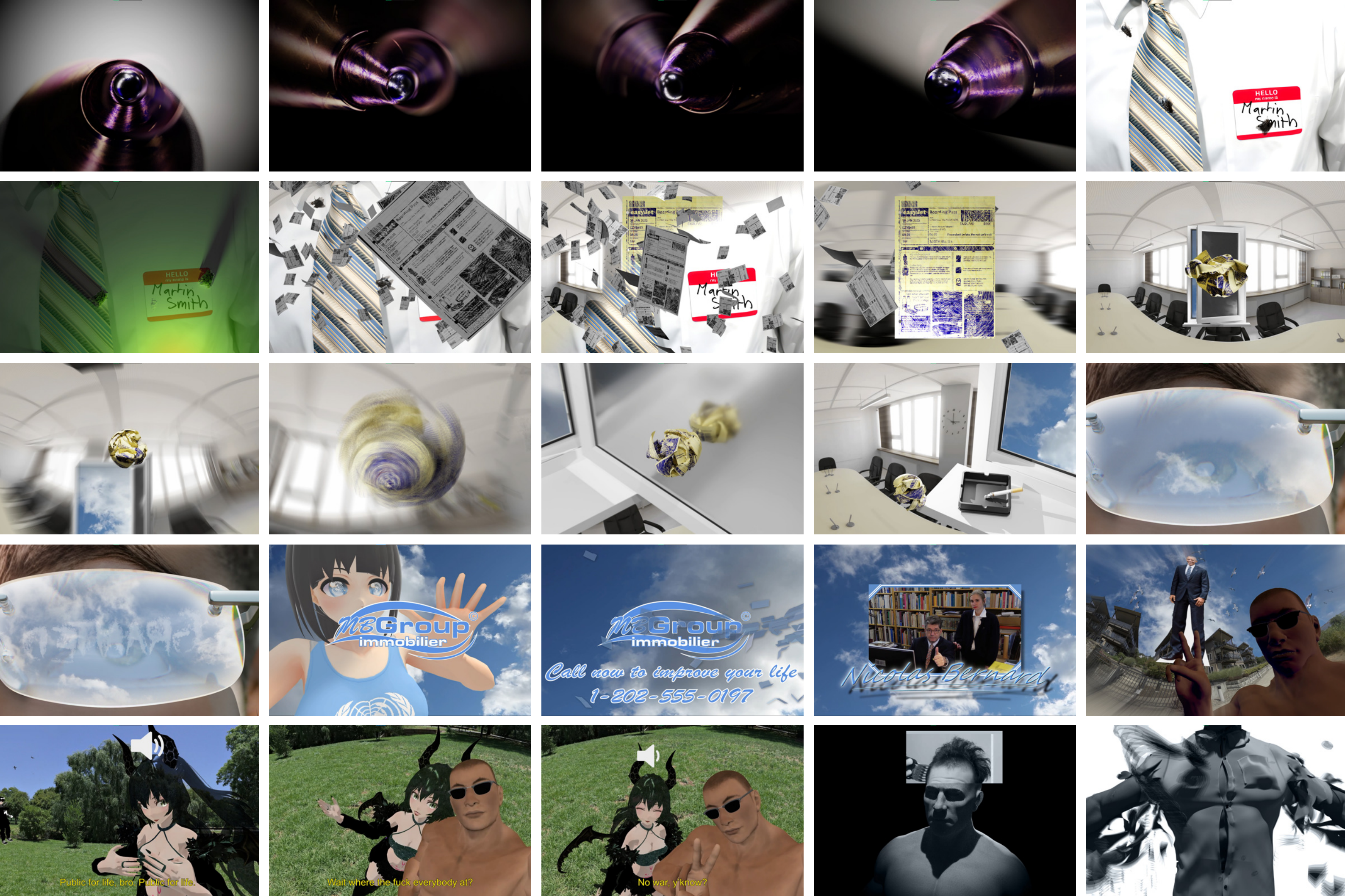
A white collar worker dreams of escaping the workplace. His wish is granted when he is drawn into a strange virtual estate commercial.



MOVIE LINK: <https://vimeo.com/801785941/7804ad8111?fl=ml&fe=ec>

Poster of *PUBLIC 4 LIFE*





Stills from PUBLIC 4 LIFE



CHILDPROOF, 2023, 1h05'49"

Is a film/performance where I embody a made-up superhero called CHILDPROOF who has to smoke as much as possible in order to make himself sterile. Where superman is bullet-proof, he is child-proof.





*CHILDPROOF*, 2023, single-channel HD video (silent), 4.52:1 format, 1h05'49"

MOVIE LINK: <https://vimeo.com/1078028616/841ba18afa?fl=pl&fe=sh>



TARGET AUDIENCE, 2024

is a performance in which the artist's brother replaces them at some point during a group exhibition opening.







*TARGET AUDIENCE, 2024, performance*